



University launch readiness audit: HECVAT compliance, WCAG 2.2 accessibility, and a go-live checklist across registration and LMS modules

Computer

Higher-ed SaaS contract & go-to-market matrix: SLA tiers, data governance, and pricing models for university buyers

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Show me the HECVAT compliance checklist

How should we handle student data migration

What does our first pilot contract look like

I created a complete university launch-readiness and pilot-contract playbook for Semester. It includes a HECVAT preparation tracker, WCAG 2.2 go-live controls, registration and LMS launch checklists, a student-data migration approach, SLA and packaging matrix, and a first-pilot contract outline.

What it includes

- **HECVAT readiness checklist** across governance, privacy, FERPA posture, authentication, application security, database controls, resilience, AI governance, and accessibility.
- **WCAG 2.2 AA go-live checklist** for keyboard navigation, focus, screen-reader use, contrast, zoom/reflow, reduced motion, captions, accessible documents, and issue handling.
- **Registration launch controls** for course planning, source freshness, backup courses, advisor agendas, hold categories, official handoffs, load testing, and safe failure states.
- **LMS and Course Studio controls** for content authorization, syllabus extraction review, source-linked study assets, course AI policies, active-assessment safeguards, LTI, and official-grade boundaries.
- **A structured student-data migration playbook:** discovery, classification, minimization, mapping, sample import, validation, reconciliation, parallel run, cutover, archive/export, and monitoring.
- **A first Semester Registration and Path Pilot Agreement** outline, including scope, exclusions, DPA terms, institutional and Semester responsibilities, security, support, pricing, success measures, and exit/data-return provisions.
- **SaaS package tiers** and a go-live command-center template.

HECVAT is intended to help higher-education institutions assess vendor risk across cybersecurity, privacy, accessibility, and compliance, so the checklist should become your evidence tracker rather than a one-time document. WCAG 2.2 provides the current accessibility

guidance baseline for making web content usable across a broad range of disabilities. [¹1857]^[1]
^[2] ^[3]

Most important next actions

1. Assign an owner, status, due date, and evidence link to each HECVAT row.
2. Complete the database RLS and SECURITY DEFINER remediation register before connecting broad institutional records.
3. Use the pilot-contract outline as the basis for attorney-reviewed MSA, Pilot SOW, and DPA documents.
4. Select one pilot cohort and complete the registration and LMS checklists using real test results.
5. Run a formal go/no-go review covering data scope, access controls, accessibility, support, monitoring, backup/restore, and rollback readiness.

The document is available in the file panel as “semester-university-launch-readiness-and-pilot-contract.”

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1. <https://www.educause.edu/higher-education-community-vendor-assessment-toolkit>
2. <https://www.educause.edu/higher-education-community-vendor-assessment-toolkit/hecvat-faqs-for-higher-education>
3. <https://www.w3.org/WAI/WCAG22/Understanding/>
4. https://accessible-eu-centre.ec.europa.eu/content-corner/digital-library/web-content-accessibility-guidelines-wcag-22_en